

UniTrade Brand and Design System

The single source of truth for how UniTrade looks, speaks and feels, across the web, mobile and print.

Version

2.0

Platform

Web and Mobile

Context

South African Universities





Colour Palette

BRAND COLOURS

#0D1F4E

Primary 700
RGB 13, 31, 78
Headers, primary buttons, brand, nav — canonical navy

#1A3A7A

Primary 500
RGB 26, 58, 122
Hover state for primary elements

#0A1840

Primary 800
RGB 10, 24, 64
Footers, deep-emphasis hover, dark-mode surface

#04B4FD

Secondary 500
RGB 4, 180, 253
Borders, dividers, badges — never white text on this (see contrast table)

SEMANTIC COLOURS

#059669

Success 600
RGB 5, 150, 105
Confirmations, live/active status

#E11D48

Error 600
RGB 225, 29, 72
Destructive actions, rejected/cancelled status

#F59E0B

Warning 500
RGB 245, 158, 11
Pending / needs-review status

#0A1840

Info 700
RGB 10, 24, 64
Informational toasts — reuses primary-800

WCAG 2.2 CONTRAST REFERENCE

Foreground	Background	Ratio	Result
White	● Primary 700	15.87:1	AAA
Black	○ White	21:1	AAA
White	● Secondary 500	2.35:1	FAIL
Black	● Secondary 500	8.96:1	AAA
White	● Success 600	3.77:1	AA (large only)
White	● Error 600	4.69:1	AA

Foreground	Background	Ratio	Result
White	 Info 700	17.25:1	AAA
Gray 500	 White	4.83:1	AA (marginal)

DARK MODE

LIGHT

Body text on white

Card surfaces, gray-200 borders

DARK

Body text on primary-800

Card surfaces, white/10 borders

Do

Use Primary 700 as the single canonical navy

Use black or Primary 700 text on Secondary 500 backgrounds

Reserve Primary 800 for footers, deep hover states, and dark-mode surfaces

Verify any new colour pairing against WCAG 2.2 AA before shipping

Don't

Don't introduce a new 'close enough' navy hex

Don't put white text directly on Secondary 500 (fails contrast)

Don't use red as a button fill — it's reserved for destructive/error states

Don't ship a dark-mode surface without checking its contrast separately from light mode

Typography

UniTrade uses **Fraunces** for headings paired with **Inter** (or the designer's chosen font) for the body. Fraunces is a free Google Font under SIL Open Font License. It is very important to follow the same font for headings as specified in this guide for uniformity.

ROLE	FONT & WEIGHT	SIZE	LINE HEIGHT	LIVE SAMPLE
Display (marketing hero only)	Fraunces Bold 700	40px / 2.5rem	1.15	Buy and sell on your campus
H1 - Page title	Fraunces Regular-SemiBold	32px / 2rem	1.2	Browse Listings
H2 - Section heading	Inter SemiBold 600	24px / 1.5rem	1.3	What We Offer
H3 - Card title	Inter SemiBold 600	18px / 1.125rem	1.4	Biology Textbook
Body	Inter Regular 400	16px / 1rem	1.5	Reserve now to hold this item for 24 hours.
Body Small	Inter Regular 400	14px / 0.875rem	1.5	Good condition, minor highlighting on pages 3-5.
Caption / Meta	Inter Regular 400	12px / 0.75rem	1.4	BIO121 · Listed 7 May 2026 · 42 views
Overline / Eyebrow	Inter SemiBold, uppercase, 0.12em tracking	11px / 0.6875rem	1.4	SECTION LABEL

Do

Always use Fraunces for all headings not for the body

Use Inter or your chosen close enough font for everything else: H2 down through captions

Load Fraunces via Google Fonts in index.html — verify it's actually rendering, not falling back to serif

Keep the Overline/Eyebrow role for section labels only — retire ad hoc font-mono labels

Don't

Don't use conflicting fonts in one page, If no sure about fonts always use Inter for your body.

Don't use Fraunces below H1 size — it loses legibility and consistency at small sizes

Don't use more than these two font families on any page

Don't set body text below 12px

Design Tokens

The following design tokens should always be used in code. If the color is already defined in the config use that instead of tailwind default colors.

```
colors: {
  primary: { 500: '#1A3A7A', 700: '#0D1F4E', 800: '#0A1840' },
  secondary: { 500: '#04B4FD' },
  success: { 600: '#059669', 700: '#047857' },
  error: { 600: '#E11D48' },
  warning: { 500: '#F59E0B' },
  info: { 700: '#0A1840' },
},
fontFamily: {
  sans: ['Inter', 'sans-serif'],
  display: ['Fraunces', 'serif'],
},
borderRadius: { sm: '0.5rem', md: '0.75rem', lg: '1rem', xl: '1.5rem' },
animation: {
  'fade-up': 'fade-up 0.6s ease-out both',
  'pop-in': 'pop-in 0.5s ease-out both',
},
```

RADIUS SCALE



sm - 8px
Inputs, small chips



md - 12px
Buttons, badges



lg - 16px
Cards



xl - 24px
Modals, chat bubbles

MOTION TOKENS

fade-up · 0.6s ease-out

Scroll-reveal entrance - working, used throughout this page.

UI Components

BUTTONS

Reserve Item	Add to Wishlist	Delete
Type	Default	Hover
Primary	Primary 700 fill, white text	Primary 500 fill
Secondary	White, Primary 700 border/text	Secondary 500 fill, Primary 700 text (not white — contrast fix)
Destructive	Error 600 border/text	Error 600 fill, white text

STATUS BADGES

One system replacing the 2 that existed in production

Live Pending Rejected Info

Badge	Background	Text
Live / Active	Success 600 @ 10%	Success 700
Pending / Review	Warning 500 @ 10%	#7A5800
Rejected / Cancelled	Error 600 @ 10%	Error 600

CHAT BUBBLES

Sent bubble now uses the Primary 700 token, not the hardcoded #003366 found in ChatPage.tsx

Hi, is this textbook still available?	Yes it is! Can meet tomorrow at Library Cafe.
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FORM INPUTS

COURSE CODE

TOAST NOTIFICATIONS

✓ Listing uploaded successfully.

⚠ Could not add to wishlist.

i Reservation held for 24 hours.

COMPONENT RULES

Do: Reference tokens for colors.

Do: Use the radius scale from Section 3 consistently per component type

Don't: Use red as a fill for non-destructive buttons

Don't: Introduce a new button/badge variant outside this list without updating this page first

Logo & Iconography

Context	Minimum Width	Notes
Desktop / Tablet header	120px	Wordmark + icon mark
Mobile header	90px	Icon + abbreviated wordmark if needed
Print	25mm (~1 inch)	Vector format only
Favicon / App icon	32 × 32px	Icon only — no wordmark

ICON LIBRARY

Property	Rule
Library	Tabler Icons (@tabler/icons-react)
Stroke width	2 (library default)
Sizing	12-14px inline with captions · 16-18px inline with body · 20-28px standalone/feature
Colour	currentColor or an explicit token — never a raw hex

Do

- Use the logo exactly as provided — no modifications
- Use Tabler Icons exclusively for consistency — no mixing icon libraries
- Size icons per the sizing rule above based on their inline context
- Use the reversed white version on dark backgrounds

Don't

- Don't stretch or distort the logo
- Don't recolour icons with raw hex — use tokens or currentColor
- Don't mix icon libraries into a Tabler-based screen
- Don't add drop shadows or outlines to the logo

Accessibility Standards

AREA	REQUIREMENT	STATUS
Colour contrast	AA minimum per Section 1 table	△ White-on-secondary-500 fails, fix in progress
Keyboard navigation	All interactive elements reachable via Tab, visible focus	△ Needs manual keyboard-only audit
Focus indicator	2px Secondary 500 ring, never removed without replacement	△ Partial - some buttons lack a custom focus style
Screen reader support	Meaningful alt text, aria-label on icon-only buttons	△ Partial - nav has aria-labels, icon-only buttons need a pass
Reduced motion	Respect prefers-reduced-motion	✓ Implemented on this page's Reveal wrapper - extend app-wide
Automated audit score	Record Lighthouse/axe score here	△ Not yet run - placeholder

Voice & Tone

Trustworthy, not cold

Protect users without hiding behind legalese.

Student-first, not academic

Short sentences. Active voice. Real language.

Direct about rules

No fine print. No hidden catches.

EXAMPLES

"You can't reserve your own listing."

"Please pick a module from the list"

Brand Mascot - Alex



Alex is a mascot, not a logo variant

Alex appears exclusively on the marketing homepage hero (desktop layout) and cycles through a friendly thinking → answer → joy sequence. Alex should never replace the wordmark or icon mark in navigation, favicons, or official documents.

Do

Use Alex only on the marketing homepage hero

Keep Alex's tone playful and light, it's a personality touch, not a functional UI element

Don't

Don't use Alex as a substitute for the wordmark or icon in official contexts

Don't add Alex to dashboard/utility screens — it's a marketing-only touch

Changelog from Demo 1

All the changes for demo 1 guide are documented on this part of the guide.

Replaced Poppins with Fraunces

Fraunces font is a very suitable font for page headings hence why we are now using that font.

Added a semantic colour system (success/error/warning/info)

The Toast component needed a real documented home for its states

Added a WCAG 2.2 contrast table with real computed ratios

Demo 2 spec specifies that we need accessibility rules hence why this part was added.

Documented dark mode for the first time

Dark mode is used through out the app but was never documented.

Added a radius scale

Different radius values are being used in the code without being documented.

Documented the Toast component and fixed its icon bug

Toasts are really important for relating errors, successes or info to the users.

Rebuilt this page's hero to match the homepage hero

This was done for uniformity all the cover pages should look fairly similar.

Reframed Alex as a mascot, not a logo variant

Clarifies how Alex should be used in the system.

Added an Accessibility Standards section

Accessibility is a very important NFR hence we need rules to meet the standards.

Replaced invented tone-of-voice examples with examples

These were mainly added for guidance.

